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LINEAGE

SSA & PERC.

CME Building Bridges

Lineage

Andrea Ramsey

Doreen Rao's

choralMUSIC
-experience-

BOOSEY & HAWKES



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PROGRAM NOTE

Margaret Walker's poem leapt off the page at me—these words were crying to be sung. I was drawn to the strength of the grandmothers described by Walker. This was not frailty—this was determined womanhood. In setting the music, I aimed for an earthy—at times, an even bluesy feel. Not bluesy in the commercial sense, but in the heart-and-gut sense. Percussion was added to enhance the primitive, organic framework around which the piece was constructed. Singers are encouraged to pay special attention to syllabic stress and choices of when to apply and release weight in the tone.

TEXT

*My grandmothers were strong.
They followed plows and bent to toil.
They moved through fields sowing seed.
They touched earth and grain grew.
They were full of sturdiness and singing.
My grandmothers were strong.*

*My grandmothers are full of memories
Smelling of soap and onions and wet clay
With veins rolling roughly over quick hands
They have many clean words to say.
My grandmothers were strong.
Why am I not as they?*

ABOUT THE COMPOSER

Composer, conductor and teacher, Dr. Andrea Ramsey is a native of Arkansas. Her teaching experiences range from work with adolescent and children's voices to frequent guest conducting of all-state and honor choirs, to her current position as the Associate Director of Choral Studies at The University of Colorado, Boulder. An active member of ACDA, ASCAP, and NAfME, Andrea believes strongly in the power of meaningful choral music to provide human connections, opportunities for musical growth, and a valuable outlet for self and group expression. As ASCAPPlus award winning composer with over 70 compositions in print to date, Ramsey is regularly commissioned by ensembles and enjoys composer-in-residence opportunities as well.

DURATION

ca. 3 min.

EDUCATION THROUGH ARTISTRY

*Building Self-Growth and Self-Esteem
through Choral Singing*

CME Building Bridges

(Marguerite McCormick, advisor)

For developing choirs including middle school, junior high and beginning level high school singers, this CME series features a culturally diverse and educationally conceived choral repertoire composed and arranged to motivate and inspire continued musical growth through the transition years. Interchangeable voicings are often used.

Commissioned by Sister Singers Network and premiered on July 26, 2014

LINEAGE

SSA a cappella and percussion*

Words by
Margaret Walker

Music by
Andrea Ramsey

Earthy, with confidence ♩ = ca. 90

Tutti Unison Voices

Sandpaper Blocks or Cabasa

High Drum Low Drum

mf

My grand-moth-ers were

5

strong. My grand-moth-ers were strong. —

mf

8

They fol-lowed plows — and bent to toil. They moved through

* Percussion parts are included on pages 14-16.

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11

fields____ sow - ing seed.____ *mp* My grand-moth-ers were

fields____ sow - ing seed.____ *mp* My grand-moth-ers were

fields____ sow - ing seed.____ *mp* My grand-moth-ers were

The piano accompaniment consists of two staves. The right hand plays a steady eighth-note accompaniment, while the left hand plays a similar pattern, often with rests.

14

strong. *p* My grand-moth-ers were strong.

strong. *p* My grand-moth-ers were strong.

strong. *mf* Hm *mp* Hm

The piano accompaniment continues with the same eighth-note pattern in both hands, with some variations in the left hand's rhythm.

17 *f*

They touched the earth and grain

f

They touched the earth and grain

f

They touched the earth and grain

p *mf*

fz *fz* *fz*

20

grew. They touched the earth__

grew. They touched the earth__

grew. They touched the earth__

p *mf* *p*

p *mf* *fz* *fz*

23 *mp*

and grain — grew

mp

and grain — grew

mp

and grain — grew

mf *p*

fz *p*

26 *mf* a mournful distant cry

Ooh

mf

My grand-moth-ers were strong. My grand-moth-ers were

mf

My grand-moth-ers were strong. My grand-moth-ers were

mf *ff*

29

mp Ooh and

f strong. — They were full of stur-di-ness and *mp*

f strong. — They were full of stur-di-ness and *mp*

32

mf sing - ing, — sing - ing, — sing - ing, —

cresc. poco a poco sing - ing, — sing - ing, — sing - ing, — sing - ing,

mf sing - ing, — sing - ing, — *f* sing - ing, —

35 *cresc. poco a poco* *rit.* ***ff***

sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing.

rit. ***ff***

sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing.

f *rit.* ***ff***

sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing, sing - ing.

p *rit.* *mf*

p *mf*

38 *molto rit.* ***mf*** *a distant wail*

Ooh, Ooh oo

mp *molto rit.*

My grand-moth - ers are strong.

mp *molto rit.*

My grand-moth - ers are strong.

molto rit.

molto rit.

Slightly slower ♩ = ca. 78

42 *mf*

My grand-moth-ers are full of mem - 'ries.

My grand-moth-ers are full of mem - 'ries.

My grand-moth-ers are full of mem - 'ries.

Slightly slower ♩ = ca. 78

mp

45 *f*

My grand-moth-ers are full of mem - o - ries,--

My grand-moth-ers are full of mem - o - ries,--

My grand-moth-ers are full of mem - o - ries,--

mf

48

mf Smell-ing of soap and on - ions, and

mf Smell-ing of soap and on - ions, and

mf Smell-ing of soap and on - ions, and

f



51

wet clay, With veins roll-ing rough-ly o - ver

wet clay, With veins roll-ing rough-ly o - ver

wet clay, With veins roll-ing rough-ly o - ver



54

quick hands They have man-y clean words_ to say. They have

quick hands They have man-y clean words_ to say. They have

quick hands They have man-y clean words_ to say. They have

57

Tempo primo ♩ = ca. 90

man - y clean words_ to say.

man - y clean words_ to say.

man - y clean words_ to say.

Tempo primo ♩ = ca. 90

60

mp My grand-moth-ers were strong. *p* My grand-moth-ers were

mp My grand-moth-ers were strong. *p* My grand-moth-ers were

mp My grand-moth-ers were strong. Hm

ff *p* *p*

63

strong. My grand-moth-ers were strong.

strong. My grand-moth-ers were strong.

p Hm *p* Hm

66

f *mp*
Why am I not as
f *mp*
Why am I not as

mf *ff*
mf *ff*

70

sfz
Hmm
sfz
they? Hmm
sfz
they? Hmm

p *mf*
mp

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LINEAGE

Sandpaper Blocks or Cabasa

Words by Margaret Walker
Music by Andrea Ramsey

Earthy, with confidence ♩ = ca. 90

4

mf

9

(8)

(12)

17

p *mf* *p* *mf*

22

p *mf* *p* *mf*

27

(4)

35

p *mf* *rit.* *molto rit.* 3

42

Slightly slower ♩ = ca. 78

mp *mf*

47

f

53

(4)

Tempo Primo ♩ = ca. 90

mf

60

(4)

ff *p*

68

mf *ff* *p* *mf*

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LINEAGE

High Drum /
Low Drum

Words by Margaret Walker
Music by Andrea Ramsey

Earthy, with confidence ♩ = ca. 90

mf

6

10

14

18

fz fz fz p mf

22

fz fz fz p

26

ff

31

35

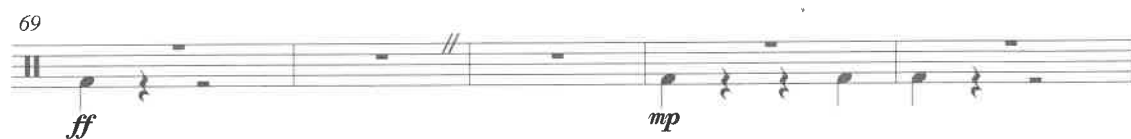
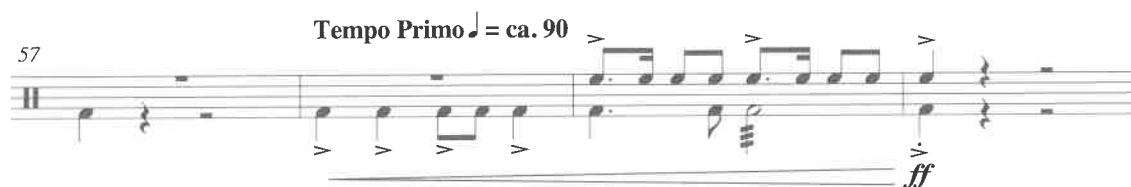
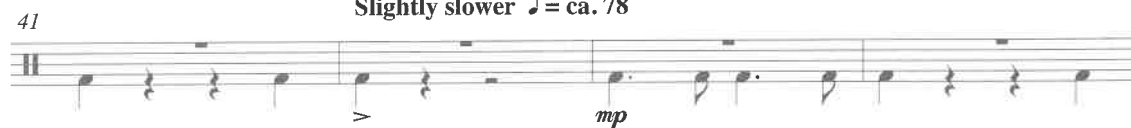
p rit. mf molto rit. 2

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Slightly slower $\text{♩} = \text{ca. } 78$ 

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